

# Plank Product Data Platform — Domain Glossary

*The meaning-and-rules companion to the Line Detail Data Dictionary. The dictionary says **what's in the data**; this says **what we mean and how things are calculated**. Keep both in the Claude Project. Items marked  **TO CONFIRM** need your input — they're institutional knowledge not derivable from the data.*

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## 1. Metric definitions

*These drive every dashboard, so precision matters.*

- **Return rate** — measured **three ways** in the returns report: **units** (units returned ÷ units sold ≈ 7.15% in Q1), **orders** (returned orders ÷ orders ≈ 9.94%), and **value** (returns cash ÷ total cash ≈ 6.58%). Always reported against **LQ** and **LY**. **Authoritative count = Returns zap**, not Shopify (Shopify undercounts).  **Denominator window still TO CONFIRM**: some SKU rates exceed 100% because returns in a period are divided by *sales in the same period* — returns of earlier-bought stock overshoot. Decide the basis (same-period / rolling / returns matched to their original sale period).
- **Newness window** — "new or older than 6 months", a 6-month boundary
- **Continuity** — Continuity is core/carry over, older than 6 months
- **Top-10 returns** — rank SKUs by **return value (£)** and by **return rate**, and use both: value surfaces big-ticket problems, rate surfaces defective lines. Apply a **minimum units-sold threshold** on the rate view to filter tiny-volume noise.
- **Comparison periods** (confirm exact definitions):
  - **MoM** — month on month (calendar)
  - **LM** — last month
  - **LY** — last year
  - **WC** — week commencing
  - **YoY** — year on year (if used)
- **Channels**:
  - **D2C** — direct-to-consumer (own Shopify stores)
  - **B2B** — business/trade (e.g. B&Q, trade customers, almost exclusively US market)

## Returns reason taxonomy (7 categories, from Returns zap)

The single most useful cut for the product team: **~89% of returns are choice/fit**, **~11% are genuine product issues**.

- **Choice / fit (~89%):** Not right for my project (~56%) · Ordered multiple options or samples to try (~19%) · Other (~13%)
- **Product issue (~11%):** Disappointed in quality (~5%) · Finish not as pictured online (~4%) · Incorrect item sent (~1.4%) · Damaged or Defective (~0.7%)

The product-quality signal lives in that ~11% bucket and where it concentrates by SKU. The **structured Return Reason** field is reliable; the free-text **Please tell us why** is sparse and noisy (use as colour, not core data).

## 2. Margin & pricing rules

- **Target margin:** 75% gross margin, **ex-VAT**.
- **Charm pricing:** RRP set to **£x.95**.
- **RRP structure:** a single **blended RRP per product form** (not per variant).
- **VAT treatment (important):** **RRP in GBP is VAT-inclusive; RRP in USD is ex-tax**. Margins are computed against an **ex-VAT** RRP (GBP inc-VAT ÷ 1.20; USD used as-is).
- **Gross margin %** =  $(\text{RRP ex-VAT} - \text{supplier cost}) \div \text{RRP ex-VAT}$ .
- **Landed margin** =  $(\text{RRP ex-VAT} - \text{landed cost}) \div \text{RRP ex-VAT}$ , where **landed cost** =  $\text{supplier cost} \times (1 + \text{freight\%} + \text{duty\%})$ .
- **Duty %** is selected by **product category + country of origin** from the Margin Grid (e.g. China→US handle ≈ 21.37%, hook ≈ 38.37%, fixed lighting ≈ 43.07%; UK mostly 0%; India→US ≈ 10.5%).
- **FX:** supplier costs convert to GBP via a **hand-maintained** rate table (dated in-sheet). ⚠ Stale unless refreshed.
- **Supplier fee:** some suppliers carry a % fee added to cost before margin. (Maxery = none.)

## 3. Status vocabularies

*Two distinct vocabularies — don't conflate them. Both should map cleanly onto the Newness tracker.*

**Lifecycle Status** (**UK Status / US Status**): | Status | Meaning | |---|---| | In Development | Not yet ordered or launched | | Launching | On order but not live | | Live | Anything live (new or older than 6 months) | | Not For Sale | Selling-related but not a live SKU | | Discontinued | Live but no longer re-ordering | | Dead | Discontinued and now out of stock | | Disco to Resource | Discontinuing to re-source (new supplier / major design change) | | Not Sold in this Market | Not offered in that market |

**Progress Status** (**Progress Stage** — the NPD/upload workflow): In Development → Ordered → Ready to Upload → Uploaded Shopify → Uploaded Everywhere → Uploaded helm; plus Paused Launch. ☐ **TO CONFIRM** the canonical order and how it aligns to the Newness tracker stages.

## 4. Kit vs Assembly

- **Kit** — a **sellable, multi-part product** (bundle) with per-market retail/status; components listed in the **Kit SKUs** tab. Cost/weight roll up from components. (e.g. *KEPLER 1G Dimmer = switch plate + dimmer detail + module.*)
- **Assembly** — an **internal/trade build**, usually "Not For Sale" (e.g. trade sample boards); components in the **Assembly SKUs** tab.
- ⚠ Component rollups ignore **Required Quantity** (fine while quantities = 1 — confirm for multi-quantity kits).

## 5. Naming conventions (canonical for the platform)

*Adopted to kill the Product Type/Category confusion between sheets.*

- **department** = broadest grouping (Cabinetry, Door, Accessories, Taps, Electric, Lighting, Components) — the Margin Grid's "Product Type".
- **item\_type** = the product kind (Handle, Knob, Hook, Wall Light...).
- **style** = the variant/style (T Bar, Ring Pull, Knurled...).
- ⚠ The source sheets label "Product Type" and "Product Category" **oppositely** — always use the canonical names above downstream.
- **SKU** is the only reliable unique key (the 3-digit product code is not unique).

**SKU code system:** **Category Code** (C/D/A/T/E/L/X) + **Product Code** (2 letters) = 3-digit code (e.g. C + TB = **CTB**). Full SKUs also encode market (prefix unless Global), **KIT-** for kits, and **-R** for replacements.

## 6. Finishes & families

- **Finish codes:** BR (Brass), SS (Stainless), BK (Black), AB (Antique Brass), AG (Aged Brass), UB (Unlacquered Brass), PB (Polished Brass), HB (Heirloom Brass), BB (Blackened Bronze), PN (Polished Nickel), BN (Brushed Nickel), PC (Polished Chrome), WH, GR, GY, PI, BU, PU, YE, OR, RD, WN, OA, DO, CL, LB, BG, MU, PA, GS, BE, CM, CT, EM, PNB (Nickel + Unlacquered Brass)... (full map in dictionary §15b).
- **Coordinating finish families / sets** —  **TO CONFIRM** which finishes are marketed as coordinating sets (e.g. which brass tones pair with which nickels), for cross-sell and set bundles.
- **Material codes:** Brass=1, Stainless=2, Aluminium=3, ... (dictionary §15b).

## 7. Markets & currency

- **Markets tracked:** UK, US, Ireland (EUR), Australia, Canada, Channel Islands.
- **SKU market scope** (**Country Availability**): US · GB · Global.

- **Authoritative price fields:** **RRP in GBP** (inc VAT) and **RRP in USD** (ex tax).  
Per-market **Price** / columns are grid-derived and often blank — ☐ confirm whether they're used downstream or legacy.
- **Currencies:** supplier costs in GBP / USD / EUR; converted to GBP via the hand-maintained FX table.

## 8. Ads & merchandising tags

- **Included/Excluded in Ads** values: **CORE · STANDARD · EXCLUDE** ☐ confirm the practical meaning of each (which ad sets/budgets they map to).

## 9. Known data caveats (carried from the dictionary)

- **Imperial weight is broken** in the sheet ("0oz") — recompute ( $\text{kg} \times 35.274$ ).
- **Launch Date is free text** (e.g. "pre-2022") — needs cleaning to parse.
- **Mixed boolean encodings** — Yes/No vs TRUE/FALSE.
- **3-digit product code is not unique** (**EDP**, **XSS** collide) — use SKU as key.
- **Product Type/Category labels reversed** between the Line Detail and the prep tab.
- **FX and duty grids are hand-maintained** — treat as living, staleness-prone reference; the duty grid encodes current US tariff policy and needs ongoing ownership.
- **Discontinued stock returns ~4× higher** than Live ( $\approx 25.7\%$  vs  $\approx 6.9\%$ ) — clearance lines inflate the rate; segment them out when reading the trend.
- **Return rate can exceed 100%** for some SKUs (returns of earlier-period stock ÷ same-period sales) — a denominator/timing artifact, not real; see §1.

## 10. Reconciled revenue basis

- ☐ **TO CONFIRM** — state the correct headline revenue figure/basis here (the reconciled number, and what it includes/excludes), so it's fixed once and can't drift across reports. This was a source of error in a previous report, so pinning it explicitly matters.

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*Sources: built from the Line Detail Data Dictionary (§1–16) and prior analysis. Update the ☐ items and this becomes the definitive reference for the platform and for handover.*